virulent anti-Zionist, dismissive of Jewish nationalist efforts to bolster characteristics which "strike other people. . .as not always of the pleasantest kind." Antisemitism, he believed, was a natural reaction to the reality of Jewish economic and cultural domination in places like Vienna or Budapest.

Before the First World War, Zionism was still very much a minority movement within the Jewish world. Its most resolute opponents were generally Jews. As early as 1882, Vienna's leading preacher, Adolf Jellinek, vigorously protested to Leo Pinsker—founder of Hibbat Zion in Russia—that if he [Jellinek] were to raise up "the sky-blue flag of a Jewish State and political nation, then I would have to deny my entire past and retract all the sermons that I have delivered. . .and published in more than thirty years."[3]

His successor as Chief Rabbi of Vienna, Moritz Güdemann, complained twenty-five years later, that Zionism represented a dangerous retreat into national separatism. "For centuries," Güdemann wrote to a correspondent in 1907, "the Christians have accused the Jews of isolating themselves. And suddenly such isolation is to be a panacea? The poison is now to serve as an antidote? That is no sensible cure."[4]

Most Jewish anti-Zionism of this type was obviously not motivated by antisemitism. Religious critics, including the *Protestrabbiner* in Germany and the anti-Zionist Orthodox rabbis in Russia and Eastern Europe, feared Zionism above all as a "heretical" secular movement. They saw it as an alarming challenge to the authority of the Torah and the rabbis, to the prevailing self-definition of Jewry as primarily a religious community; and as a blasphemous repudiation of the messianic promises of Divine Redemption. As for the Reform Jews, especially in Germany, Britain, and the United States, Zionism to them seemed like a reactionary retreat into a parochial and narrow nationalism, abandoning the grandiose vision of a universal Jewish "mission" in the Diaspora.[5]

In Great Britain, on the eve of the Balfour Declaration in October 1917, it was the one Jew in the liberal Lloyd George government, Edwin Montagu, the Secretary of State for India, who rejected with absolute horror the proposal of a Jewish "national home" in Palestine.[6] For Montagu, Zionism represented a potentially devastating blow to his personal status as a "patriotic Englishman." It was, he insisted, a "mischievous political creed" that would undermine Anglo-Jewry and his own credibility with the Muslims of India, for whom he was politically responsible.[7] For Montagu, the Balfour Declaration amounted to the encouragement of antisemitism by the very same British government that he had loyally served (!). For the leading Anglo-Jewish publicist of the era, Lucien Wolf, this alleged connection between Zionism and antisemitism was even more explicit. Zionism, he

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